

Μένανδρος ὁ Λαοδικεύς Ῥήτωρ

## Menander the Rhetorician of Laodicea on Demonstratives

eul\_aid: ufu

**Period:** Ὀψιμαρχαία [Late Antique](#)

**Dialect:** Κοινή [Koine](#)

**Domain:** Ῥητορική [Oratory](#)

**Format:** Λόγος [Oration](#)

Menander the Rhetorician of Laodicea was a Greek rhetorician of the late third or early fourth century CE. He is distinguished from other historical figures named Menander, such as the comic playwright. His origin is specified as Laodicea, though the precise city remains unclear.

He is the attributed author of two surviving instructional treatises on epideictic oratory: the *Division of Epideictic Speeches* and *On Epideictic Speeches*. These works provide detailed guidance for composing ceremonial speeches for various occasions, including imperial panegyrics, addresses to cities, and speeches for weddings or funerals.

Menander's significance lies in his systematization of epideictic rhetoric from the Second Sophistic. His treatises are crucial historical sources for understanding the highly formalized conventions of ceremonial oratory in the Roman Imperial era, serving as a link between earlier theorists and the later Byzantine rhetorical tradition.

### Works (2)

- Διαίρεσις τῶν ἐπιδεικτικῶν · [Division of Demonstratives](#) · 37 passages
- Περὶ ἐπιδεικτικῶν · [On Demonstratives](#) · 78 passages